

Do You Have a Data Governance Policy?

Organisations should invest in a detailed data governance policy to stay ahead of the game and to make the most of their data.



Data governance (DG) enhances data accuracy, consistency, and cleanliness through well-defined roles, organised policies, and well-enforced standards, enabling more intelligent and confident decision-making throughout the organisation. By formally delegating ownership to data stewards, custodians, and owners, it also improves accountability by guaranteeing that governance is both transparent and enforceable.

Key aspects of data management include:

- Establishing policies that dictate how data is managed and used across the organisation.
- Ensuring the accuracy, completeness, and reliability of data.
- Designing the structure of data systems, including databases and data warehouses.
- Choosing appropriate storage solutions (e.g., databases, data lakes) based on data type and access needs.
- Combining data from different sources to provide a unified view.

- Protecting data from unauthorised access and breaches.
- Using statistical and computational methods to analyse data and extract valuable insights.

Though this is a subjective concept and requires a well-thought-out information management approach, there are several tools available to implement DG within an establishment. Open source tools, too, enable easy and elegant implementation of data management (DM). The distributed streaming platform Apache Kafka is a tool for creating real-time data pipelines and streaming applications. A robust, open source object-relational database system with a wide range of features and a solid reputation for dependability is PostgreSQL. For small and medium-sized applications, another popular open source relational database management system is MySQL. Using basic programming concepts, Apache Hadoop is a system that enables the distributed processing of massive volumes of data across computer

clusters. Apache Airflow is a framework for developing, scheduling, and monitoring processes programmatically. It is frequently used for orchestrating data pipelines. Metabase is an open source business intelligence application that facilitates simple data processing and visualisation. Druid is a high-performance, distributed, column-oriented data storage system for real-time analytics.

The different data governance policies

A data governance policy is a collection of standards and guidelines aimed at the management, processing, and protection of data within an organisation. The policy is used to ensure security, consistency, and accuracy in all areas of an organisation.

This policy generally outlines the data collection, storage, processing, and disposal procedures. It also defines the roles and responsibilities of various staff members who handle the data. It aims to improve data quality and security,